

Micro Hack 1 — Business Apps

Participant Workbook · End-customer Apps (Rayfin)

FY27 EMEA EPS — Fabric Apps Motion

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Track: **End-customer Apps (Rayfin)** Scenario: **Helios Bicycle** (fictional final customer)

Print-ready PDF: [microhack-1-business-apps-workbook.pdf](#)

This is a **didactic** micro-hack. You don’t need prior Rayfin experience — every step explains **what** you do, **why**, and **what you should see**. Follow them in order.

1 Day agenda (1 day)

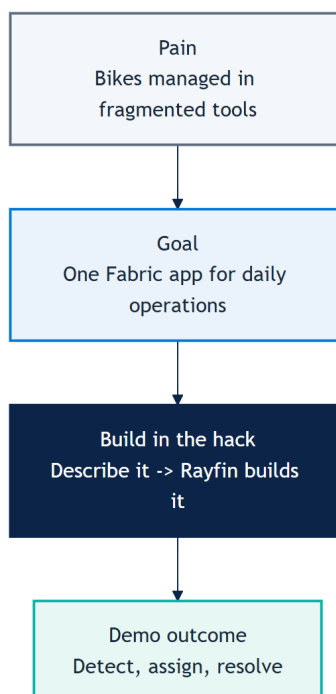
Morning — presentations & demos. Afternoon — hands-on hack. This is a **standalone one-day micro-hack for the Business Apps (Rayfin) track**.

Time	Session
09:00	Welcome & motion overview — the Fabric apps motion for EMEA
09:30	Microsoft Fabric foundations — OneLake, capacity, workspaces
10:00	Rayfin foundations — spec-driven apps, data model = database
10:30	Break
10:45	Demo · Helios Bicycle Studio — the app you'll build today
11:15	The hack brief, teams & environment check
12:00	Lunch
13:30	Hack · Sprint 1 — build the core app (steps 1–5)
15:30	Break
15:45	Hack · Sprint 2 — extend, polish & deploy (steps 6–9)
16:45	Team demos (5 min each)
17:00	Wrap-up, KPIs & next steps

2 Part A — Understand

2.1 1) The scenario in plain words

Helios Bicycle runs shared city bikes across several stations. Today the station teams track bikes, repairs and rider feedback in spreadsheets and chat — slow and error-prone. Your job in the afternoon: build **one simple app**, *Helios Bicycle Studio*, that lets a manager see every bike, fix the right one first, and keep riders happy.



2.2 2) What is Rayfin? (60-second primer)

Rayfin is a *Backend-as-a-Service on Microsoft Fabric*. In plain terms:

- You **describe your data** (e.g. a Bicycle has a code, a station, a status). Rayfin then **creates and manages the database** for you in Fabric — no SQL, no servers to run.
- You **describe your screens in natural language** (with GitHub Copilot). Rayfin generates the app UI against that data.
- So building an app becomes: *declare the data -> describe the screens -> run*.

Key idea to remember: **your data model = your database**. When you declare a Bicycle type, Rayfin makes the matching table automatically.

2.3 3) The result you are aiming for

By the end of the afternoon your app should look like this — a **Bicycle Board** and a **Live Map** of the fleet:

Helios Bicycle Board
Fleet readiness across Helios stations — live operations view

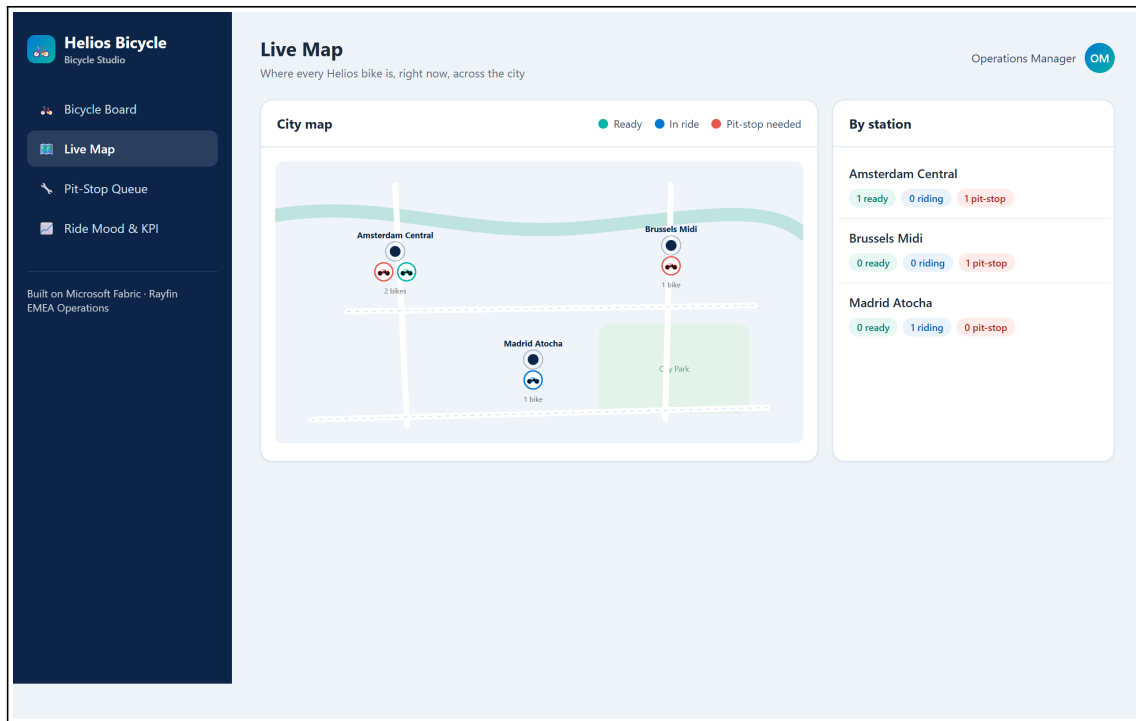
Operations Manager OM

Helios Bicycle Studio
See every bike, fix the right one first, keep riders smiling. **1/4** bikes ready now

Bicycles (4) All stations Amsterdam Central Status: any

BIKE	STATION	STATUS	RIDER MOOD	HEALTH	TAG
HB-AMS-001	Amsterdam Central	Pit-stop needed	★★★★☆ 2.8	25	⚠ Watch
HB-AMS-014	Amsterdam Central	Ready	★★★★★ 4.7	98	★ Star bike
HB-BRU-007	Brussels Midi	Pit-stop needed	★★★★☆ 3.1	40	⚠ Watch
HB-MAD-011	Madrid Atocha	In ride	★★★★★ 4.2	75	Good

Built on Microsoft Fabric · Rayfin EMEA Operations



2.4 Step 0 — Prerequisites & environment setup (do this first)

Modeled on Microsoft's [Build LAB514](#) setup. On a lab VM most tools are pre-installed.

Tools you need:

- Node.js 20+ (24 recommended) and npm
- Visual Studio Code
- **GitHub Copilot CLI** (the copilot terminal agent)

Sign in (two accounts):

1. **GitHub Copilot** — in a terminal run `copilot`, then `/login`, choose **GitHub.com**, finish the browser sign-in, confirm *"Signed in successfully"*, then `/exit`.
2. **Microsoft Fabric** — open <https://app.fabric.microsoft.com> and sign in. (If it shows *"Power BI"* bottom-left, switch it to *"Fabric"*.)

Tenant settings (ask your Fabric Administrator to enable these first). In -> **Admin portal** -> **Tenant settings**, search and enable both, clicking **Apply** each time:

- **"Users can create Fabric items"** — search *"Fabric items"* -> enable -> **Apply**.
- **"Users can discover and create org apps (preview)"** (Fabric Apps) — search *"org apps"* -> enable -> **Apply**.

Without these two tenant settings, deploying a Rayfin app to Fabric fails. They are **tenant-admin** settings — a non-admin participant cannot turn them on themselves.

Fabric workspace & capacity: create (or use) a workspace assigned to a **Fabric capacity** that supports these items — this is where your app deploys. A capacity-less (Pro-only) workspace will

not host the app.

Verify your setup:

```
node --version
npm --version
copilot --version
```

First deploy uses rayfin login + rayfin up. Once you have scaffolded the project (Step 1), the **first time** you bring it up, run these two explicitly before relying on the `npm run dev` loop — they authenticate you against Fabric (Entra) and create the app item:

```
npx rayfin login      # interactive Entra sign-in (also fixes later 401/403)
npx rayfin up        # first full deploy: creates the Fabric item +
  ↪ provisions the DB
```

You must test from inside Fabric. A Rayfin app is connected to a Fabric semantic model, so opening the raw app URL in a normal browser tab shows “**Can’t open this app outside Fabric — Opening apps connected to semantic models outside of the Fabric portal is not supported at this time.**” Always open and validate the app **from the Fabric portal** (`app.fabric.microsoft.com` -> your workspace -> the app item), not from the bare URL.

What you should see. All three commands print a version, you’re signed in to GitHub Copilot and to Fabric (capacity-backed workspace, both tenant settings enabled), and `npx rayfin up` prints a live Fabric app link.

3 Part B — Build it step by step

How to work. There is no repository to clone for this track — Rayfin scaffolds the whole project for you with one command (Step 1). After that you build the app **conversationally** with the **GitHub Copilot CLI** (`copilot` in your terminal): you give it a short prompt, it writes the code, and you check the result in the browser. Each step below = one action + **what you should see**.

Who does what — Copilot vs. the Rayfin CLI (read once)

This is the key thing to understand: **the prompt + Copilot do NOT deploy anything by themselves.**

- **GitHub Copilot** = writes/edits your TypeScript: the data model in `rayfin/data/` and the screens. It does **not** touch Fabric or your database.
- **The Rayfin CLI** = *you* run it. It deploys to Fabric, **provisions the database from your data model**, and hosts the app. `npm run dev` wraps this for the dev loop.

So the rhythm is: *ask Copilot to write code -> run a CLI command to deploy/provision -> look at the app.*

Command	What it does
<code>npm run dev</code>	Dev loop: deploys (rayfin up) + serves the app for fast iteration. Use this most of the time.
<code>npx rayfin up</code>	Full deploy to Fabric: creates the app item, applies the DB schema from your data model, builds & uploads the UI, prints the live URL.
<code>npx rayfin up db apply</code>	After you change rayfin/data/, push only the new schema (add --force if it warns about data loss).
<code>npx rayfin up staticapp deploy</code>	Redeploy only the frontend (faster).
<code>npx rayfin up status</code>	Show the current deployment.
<code>npx rayfin up --dry-run</code>	Preview a deploy without changing anything.
<code>npx rayfin login --tenant <tenant-id></code>	Re-authenticate if you hit a 401/403 (scope to your Entra tenant).

Auth note. Email/password sign-in only works in local dev. Once deployed to Fabric, only **Fabric brokered auth (Entra SSO)** works — rayfin.yml must have `auth.fabric.enabled: true`.

The build loop (what happens between prompts)

Every build step follows the same rhythm:

1. **You** give the GitHub Copilot CLI a short prompt.
2. **Copilot** writes/edits the code **and validates it for you** — it type-checks (tsc), lints (eslint), builds (npm run build) and runs the unit tests, fixing issues until green.
3. **You** run `npm run dev` to see the change in the browser (it re-deploys and re-provisions the database if the data model changed).
4. **You** sanity-check the screen, then move to the next prompt.

If Copilot reports build/test errors it couldn't fix on its own, paste the error back to it — that's the normal loop. Don't move on while the build is red.

3.1 Step 1 — Create the project (no clone needed)

What you do. Scaffold a Rayfin project. “Scaffold” means *generate a ready-to-run starter project* — you do **not** clone any repo.

```
npm create @microsoft/rayfin@latest -- "MyRayfinApp"
cd MyRayfinApp
```

Choose the Data template when prompted. It provides a Fabric-authenticated React + Vite app wired for Rayfin data — you add entities in rayfin/data/.

Why. Rayfin gives you a complete app skeleton (data layer + UI) so you start from something that already runs.

What you should see. A new project folder is created and dependencies install.

3.2 Step 2 — Run the empty app first (your “it works” check)

What you do. Start the starter app **before changing anything** — exactly like a Hello World, to confirm your environment and Fabric connection are healthy.

```
npx rayfin login --tenant <votre tenant> # first time only (or on a
  ↪ 401/403) – interactive Entra sign-in
npx rayfin up --workspace "VOTRE NOM DE WORKSPACE" # first full deploy:
  ↪ creates the Fabric item + provisions the DB
```

Why. The first `npx rayfin up` authenticates you and **creates the Fabric app item**, then provisions your database from the data model in `rayfin/data/*.ts`. `npm run dev` wraps `rayfin up` for the fast iteration loop, but running `login + up` once up front makes the first deploy reliable. If the starter app opens, your whole chain works and you can safely start customizing.

What you should see. `npx rayfin up` prints a **live Fabric app link**; open it **from the Fabric portal** and the starter app loads, with the new app showing in your workspace. **Don’t go further until this works.**

Open it from Fabric, not the bare URL. If you paste the raw app URL into a normal browser tab you’ll get *“Can’t open this app outside Fabric — Opening apps connected to semantic models outside of the Fabric portal is not supported at this time.”* That’s expected — always validate from `app.fabric.microsoft.com` -> your workspace -> the app item.

3.3 Step 3 — Declare the data model

Before you begin. In your terminal, move to the application directory and start GitHub Copilot CLI:

```
cd MyRayfinApp
copilot
```

What you do. Tell Copilot the data your app is about. This defines the **database tables**.

Build "Helios Bicycle Studio", a fun bike-operations app on Rayfin.
Data model:

```
- Bicycle(bikeCode, station, status[ready|in-ride|pit-stop-needed],
  ↪ featured)
- RideSession(bicycle, riderAlias, moodScore, startedAt, endedAt)
- PitStopTicket(ticketCode, bicycle, station, priority[high|normal],
  status[new|assigned|done], issue, openedAt,
  ↪ assignedMechanic)
```

```
- MechanicProfile(displayName, station, active)
```

Roles: Operations Manager has full access; Mechanic sees only assigned
↪ tickets.

Style: clean, friendly, Microsoft Fluent, blue #0078d4 + teal #00b4a6.

Why. These four types become four tables. `Bicycle.status` is a fixed list of values, so the app can colour bikes by status later.

What you should see. Copilot creates `rayfin/data/*.ts` — one `@entity()` class per type, marked `@authenticated('*')`, with relationships (e.g. a `@one` link from `PitStopTicket` to `Bicycle`, and an **optional/nullable** `assignedMechanic`) — exports them from `schema.ts`, and enables the data service in `rayfin.yml` (`dialect: mssql`).

Then — apply the schema. Re-run `npm run dev` (or `npx rayfin up db apply`) so Rayfin provisions the matching tables. The screens are still empty — that's expected.

Roles are app-level — important. Rayfin's data layer only knows `authenticated` / `anonymous`; there are no per-row database roles. So the **Operations Manager vs Mechanic** split is enforced **in the app** (a role context + a header switcher; the Mechanic gets a focused “My Pit-Stops” worklist). When you ask Copilot for roles in Step 8, expect this app-layer logic — not database roles.

Load demo data — your DB starts empty. Before the screens can show anything, add data. Ask Copilot for a **Manager-only “Load demo fleet” button** that writes real rows through the data API (no hardcoded display data), then click it once:

```
Add a Manager-only "Load demo fleet" button that seeds the
↳ database with a few bikes,
mechanics, ride sessions and pit-stop tickets via the Rayfin data
↳ API (no hardcoded UI data).
```

Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> `npx rayfin up`) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

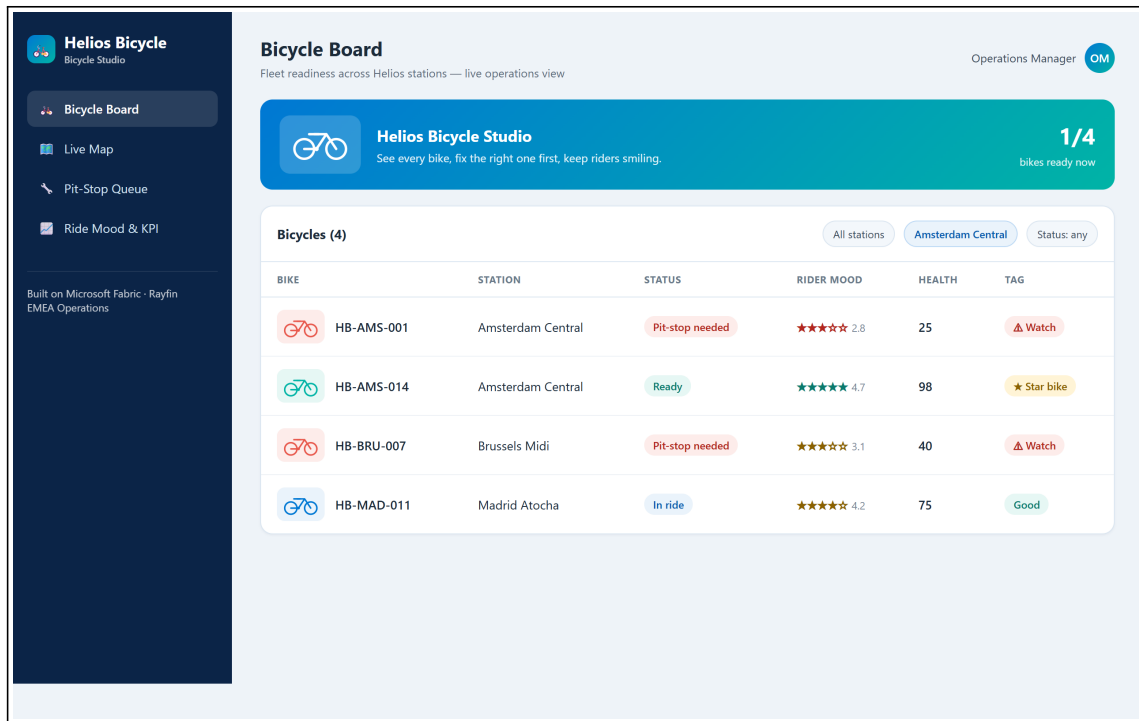
3.4 Step 4 — Build the Bicycle Board (your first screen)

What you do. Ask for the main screen: the list of bikes a manager looks at every morning.

```
Add a "Bicycle Board" screen: a table grouped by station showing a status
↳ pill,
rider mood as stars, a health score and a tag (Star / Good / Watch).
Add filters for station and status.
```

Why. This is the app's home base — *detect* which bikes need attention. The health score/tag is computed from status + mood so the manager sees priorities at a glance.

What you should see. A table of bikes by station with coloured status pills and a tag. You can filter by station and status.



Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> npx rayfin up) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

3.5 Step 5 — Build the Pit-Stop Queue (take action)

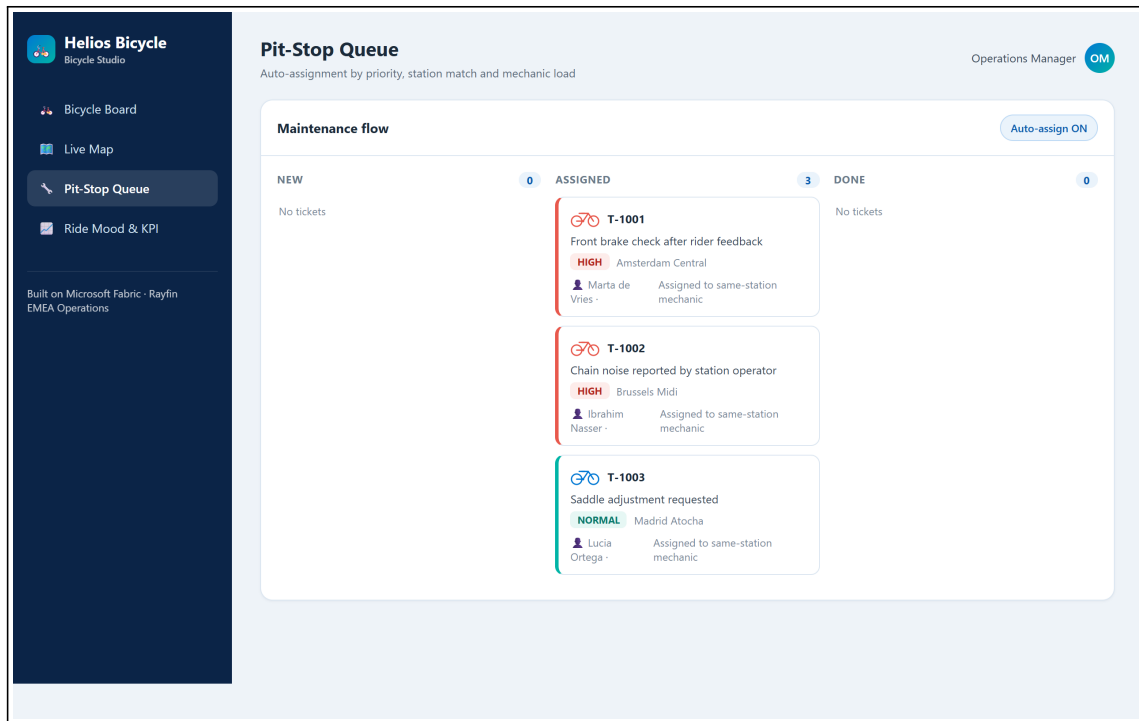
What you do. Add the screen where a manager turns a problem into an assigned repair.

Add a "Pit-Stop Queue" screen as a kanban with columns new / assigned / done.

Let me create a ticket from a bike, and assign a mechanic in one click, preferring the same-station and least-loaded mechanic.

Why. This is the *assign -> resolve* half of the story. "One click" assignment keeps the manager fast; preferring the same-station, least-busy mechanic is a simple, sensible rule.

What you should see. A three-column board. Creating a ticket from a bike places a card in **New**; assigning moves it to **Assigned** with the mechanic's name.



Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> npx rayfin up) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

Milestone (Sprint 1): Steps 1–5 give you a working app — detect a bike, open a ticket, assign it. If you reach here, you can already demo.

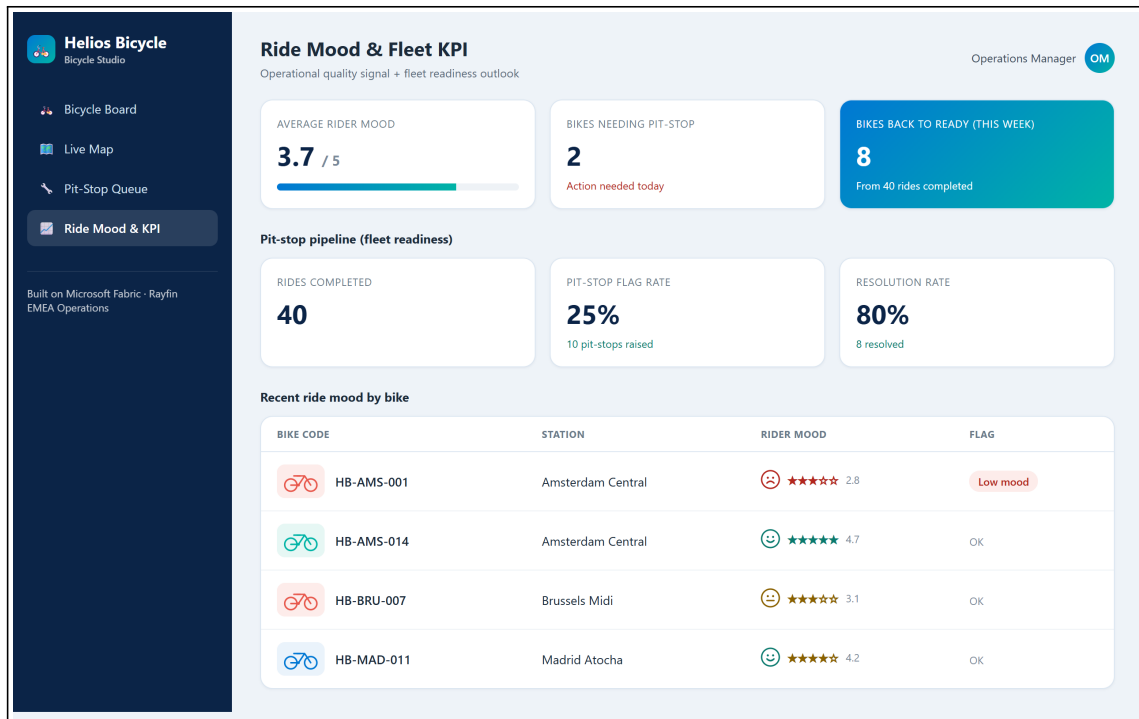
3.6 Step 6 — Add the Ride Mood & KPI screen

What you do. Add a light analytics screen.

Add a "Ride Mood & KPI" screen with cards for average rider mood, number of bikes needing a pit-stop, and a pit-stop pipeline funnel (rides completed -> pit-stops raised -> pit-stops resolved) with a flag rate, a resolution rate, and the number of bikes back to ready.

Why. Rider mood is an early quality signal; the pit-stop pipeline cards turn raw maintenance activity into a **fleet-readiness KPI** (how fast issues get bikes back on the road).

What you should see. A row of KPI cards with the average mood, the count of bikes needing a pit-stop, and the pit-stop pipeline percentages (flag rate, resolution rate, bikes back to ready).



Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> npx rayfin up) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

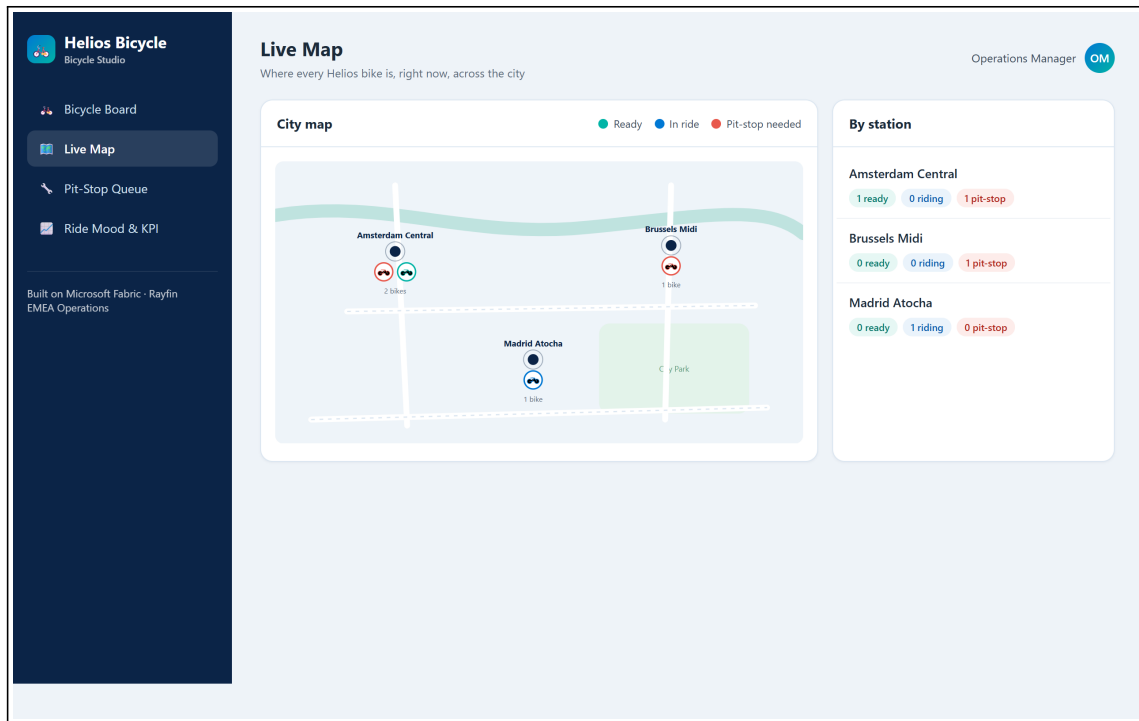
3.7 Step 7 — Add the Live Map (make it shine)

What you do. Add a map view of the fleet.

Add a "Live Map" screen: a stylized city map with one marker per bike
 ↳ colored by status (teal = ready, blue = in ride, red = pit-stop needed), plus a
 ↳ per-station summary panel.

Why. A map turns rows of data into an instantly readable picture — great for the demo and close to how operations teams think about a city fleet.

What you should see. A map with coloured bike markers and a side panel counting bikes per station.



Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> npx rayfin up) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

3.8 Step 8 — Polish (roles & visuals)

What you do. Tighten the experience. Pick what you have time for.

Make the bike rows more visual: add a colored bike illustration whose color reflects the status (teal = ready, blue = in ride, red = pit-stop needed).

Enforce roles: a Mechanic user should only see pit-stop tickets assigned to them.

Why. Visual cues speed up reading; role rules make the app realistic for a real customer rollout.

What you should see. Coloured bike icons on each row, and a mechanic account that only sees its own tickets.

Now deploy & check it in Fabric. Push this change live with [Step 9](#) and open the app from the Fabric portal. Since the app is already deployed, do a **clean redeploy every time**: first run [Annex A](#) (delete the item in Fabric -> clear local state -> npx rayfin up) so the next deploy doesn't fail with a **404**.

Milestone (Sprint 2): the app is graphical and role-aware — ready for the 5-minute demo.

3.9 Step 9 — Go live (deploy to Fabric)

What you do. Ship the app so it runs embedded in the Fabric portal with a shareable URL.

```
npx rayfin login --tenant <your-tenant-id>    # interactive Entra sign-in,  
  ↪      scoped to your tenant  
npx rayfin up                                # deploys the static app +  
  ↪      applies the schema migration
```

Pass your **tenant ID** (a GUID, or your contoso.onmicrosoft.com domain) to --tenant so the sign-in targets the right Entra tenant — useful when your account belongs to several tenants.

Why. Browser validation in Fabric needs the portal embed (interactive Entra sign-in + a workspace). `npx rayfin up` does the deploy **and** the database migration in one step, and injects the runtime `VITE_*` env vars the client needs.

What you should see. The CLI prints the **live app URL** and a Fabric portal link. Open it **from the Fabric portal** (not the bare URL — see the note below), sign in, and your Helios Bicycle Studio runs inside Fabric.

Validate inside Fabric. Opening the raw app URL outside the portal returns “Can’t open this app outside Fabric — Opening apps connected to semantic models outside of the Fabric portal is not supported at this time.” Use the **Fabric portal link** the CLI prints (or `app.fabric.microsoft.com` -> your workspace -> the app item).

Deployed already? If you later delete or hand-edit the item in Fabric before redeploying, the next `npx rayfin up` will fail with a **404** — follow [Annex A](#).

Milestone (ship): the app is deployed and demoable from a real Fabric URL.

4 Wrap-up

4.1 Team framing (fill this in 2 minutes)

- Team name:
- Who is the primary user (manager or mechanic)?
- One sentence: what does your app make faster?

4.2 Demo storyboard (5 minutes)

1. **Context** (30s): who is the user, what hurts today.
2. **Flow** (3m): detect on the Board -> open a ticket -> assign on the Queue -> show the Map.
3. **Architecture** (45s): how the data and the app connect in Fabric (Rayfin provisioned it).
4. **Next step** (45s): what you’d add before a real rollout.

4.3 Reflection

- What was the easiest part of describing the app to Rayfin?
- What did you have to clarify for Copilot to get it right?
- What metric would prove value in week 1 of production?

4.4 Reference assets

- Reference solution code: `src/apprayfin/`
- Rayfin prompt baseline (canonical spec): `src/apprayfin/src/specs/helios-bicycle-app-spec.md`
- Trainer answer key + screenshots: `docs/microhack-1-business-apps-solution.md`

5 Annex A — Redeploy cleanly after deleting the Rayfin item in Fabric

Use this when you want to **re-demo the deployment from scratch** (e.g. for a new session), or when a previous `npx rayfin up` fails with a **404** because the deployed item no longer exists.

Key fact. The Rayfin CLI has **no command to delete a deployed item** (`rayfin connector remove` exists but is unrelated). A clean teardown is done **in Fabric**, then you **clear the local state** — and the **order matters** to avoid the 404.

5.1 The golden rule

A `rayfin up 404` happens when the item was **deleted in Fabric but the local registry was kept**, so `rayfin up` tries to reuse a **dead item**. Always tear down in this order:

- 1) Delete the item in Fabric ->
- 2) clear `rayfin/.deployments.json` (and `.env`) ->
- 3) `rayfin up`.

5.2 Where your deployment lives

After a deploy, `npx rayfin up` records the live target in `rayfin/.deployments.json` — it holds the **item ID**, the **workspace** (id + name), the **live app URL**, and a **fabricDeepLink**. Open that file to find exactly what to delete. (Example shape — your IDs will differ.)

```
item      : <item-id>           e.g. bdeca1fb-...-abaada0 (helios-bicycle)
workspace : <workspace-name>    e.g. FGI-MAIN (<workspace-id>
↳ afd36cec-...-fddf74a)
live URL   : https://<sub>.webapp.fabricapps.net
fabricDeepLink : <open this to jump straight to the item in the portal>
```

5.3 Step 1 — Delete the item in Fabric

Option A — Portal (simplest). `app.fabric.microsoft.com` -> your workspace (e.g. **FGI-MAIN**) -> the **helios-bicycle** item -> ... -> **Delete**. (Or just open the **fabricDeepLink** from

rayfin/.deployments.json.)

Option B — REST (automatable, needs az login).

```
$tok = az account get-access-token --resource
↪ https://api.fabric.microsoft.com --query accessToken -o tsv
Invoke-RestMethod -Method Delete `
  -Uri "https://api.fabric.microsoft.com/v1/workspaces/<workspace-
    id>/items/<item-id>" `
  -Headers @{ Authorization = "Bearer $tok" }
```

Deleting the item also removes its **database (your seeded data)** and the **static hosting** — exactly what you want for a clean “from-scratch” demo.

5.4 Step 2 — Clear the local state (do this after the Fabric delete)

This is the step that’s easy to forget — and the cause of the 404 if skipped.

```
Remove-Item -LiteralPath ".\rayfin\.deployments.json" -Force -ErrorAction
↪ SilentlyContinue
Remove-Item -LiteralPath ".\rayfin\.env" -Force -ErrorAction
↪ SilentlyContinue
```

Then in **rayfin/rayfin.yml**, remove the old deployed URL from **allowedRedirectUris** and keep only **http://localhost:5173**. The next deploy re-adds the new URL automatically.

```
allowedRedirectUris:
- http://localhost:5173
# (the old https://<sub>.webapp.fabricapps.net line is removed – rayfin
↪ up will re-add the new one)
```

5.5 Step 3 — Redeploy on demo day

```
npx rayfin login --tenant <your-tenant-id> # if needed
npx rayfin up # you now show the CREATION of
↪ a brand-new item
```

Then open the app from the **Fabric portal** and click “**Load demo fleet**” to repopulate the database (the new item starts empty — see Step 9).

Milestone (fresh demo): a new item is created live, and the seeded data is reloaded on demand — nothing reused from the previous run.